Pre-Session Macro Brief — GER40 (DAX)

Updated — intraday refresh

Date & Session

Wednesday, 8 July 2026 — European session, intraday update (original brief published pre-open; this version reflects developments through the European afternoon).

Macro Backdrop

The US-Iran conflict has escalated materially since the morning brief: overnight US strikes hit more than 80 targets inside Iran (command-and-control networks, coastal radar, anti-ship missile sites, IRGC vessels), and Iran retaliated on Wednesday by striking US military installations in Bahrain (5th Fleet, Port Salman) and Kuwait (Ali Salem Airbase), with Iran's IRGC claiming ~85 targets hit; Iran has also threatened a "complete halt" to peace talks (NPR, 8 July 2026; PBS News, 8 July 2026; Al Jazeera, 8 July 2026). This is a step beyond the earlier "ceasefire declared over" headline — it is now an active, reciprocal exchange of strikes. Oil has extended its spike intraday (Brent above $78/bbl, WTI near $75/bbl per Euronews as of ~11:45 CEST, up 6%+ on the day) and European equities have deepened their losses, with the DAX now down roughly 2.2-2.3% intraday, more than initially reported in the pre-open brief (Euronews, 8 July 2026; Trading Economics, 8 July 2026; Investrade Morning Preview, 8 July 2026).

Scheduled Events Today (CET)

- **20:00 CET** — FOMC Minutes (16-17 June 2026 meeting, i.e. 2:00pm ET) — **High impact**. Content characterized in pre-release/early coverage as hawkish: the committee was reportedly split 9-9 on whether at least one more 2026 hike is warranted, and new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh withheld his own rate projection, leaving the minutes as the main on-record signal on a possible September hike (TechTimes, 7 July 2026; InteractiveCrypto, 8 July 2026; ING/FXStreet FX Daily, 8 July 2026). **I could not verify a confirmed, specific post-release market reaction (index levels, yield moves) with a primary/timestamped source at the time of this search** — general commentary suggests a hawkish tone should support the US dollar and pressure gold, but exact figures are unconfirmed. This release lands after the European cash close, so its direct GER40 impact would be via overnight/Thursday pre-market tone rather than today's Xetra session.
- Ongoing geopolitical/oil-supply headline risk (Strait of Hormuz, Iran-US strikes, Bahrain/Kuwait retaliation) — **High impact, event-driven**, actively moving markets through the session (NPR, PBS, Al Jazeera, Euronews — all 8 July 2026).
- German data: no major headline German release confirmed specifically for 8 July 2026 (unchanged from prior brief). German foreign trade data is due 9 July; German final CPI/HICP due 10 July 2026 (Destatis calendar, per search, 7-8 July 2026 reporting). **Exact CET release times not independently verified — confirm on a live calendar.**
- ECB: no policy event today. Next Governing Council decision 23 July 2026, 13:45 CET (unchanged).
- Fed: no policy decision today (minutes only). Next FOMC meeting 28-29 July 2026, decision due 29 July.

GER40 Context

- **Updated price action**: DAX has extended losses through the session to down approximately 2.2-2.3%, trading in the ~24,900-24,930 area — a deeper decline than the ~1%/~25,200 level noted in the earlier pre-open brief, and described as "more than one-week lows" (Investrade Morning Preview, 8 July 2026; Trading Economics, 8 July 2026; Euronews, 8 July 2026 citing the DAX shedding "more than 2.2%" around 11:00 CEST). **Note: sources show some numeric variance (e.g., one search-aggregated figure cited a**

close near 25,465, down ~1.37%, which conflicts with the more heavily corroborated ~2.2-2.3% decline to ~24,900-24,930) — treat exact index level as indicative only and verify against a live primary price feed (e.g., Xetra/Eurex) before use.

- Sector picture: broad-based declines led by banks, autos, software, tech, and industrials; utilities and some energy-linked names the relative outperformers, consistent with oil majors gaining on the crude spike (per search-aggregated market reports, 8 July 2026).
- Range/structure (unchanged from prior brief, not re-verified this pass): 52-week high near 25,507.79; 25,800 cited as a key resistance zone; 52-week low near 21,863.81 (late March 2026); support zone cited around 24,360-24,400 — now closer to today's traded range given the deepened selloff. **These technical levels remain third-party chart commentary, not independently verified against a primary feed.**
- DAX-constituent Q2 earnings dates for this week: still not verified from available sources — check a live corporate calendar (Deutsche Börse, company IR pages).

Key Watch Points

- **Geopolitical escalation is now active and reciprocal, not just declaratory.** Iran's strikes on US bases in Bahrain and Kuwait, and its threat to halt talks entirely, raise the risk of a wider regional conflict and further Strait of Hormuz disruption — this is the dominant driver of both the oil spike and the deepened GER40 decline today (NPR, PBS News, Al Jazeera, 8 July 2026).
- **FOMC minutes at 20:00 CET land after the European close** but carry unusual weight (Warsh's withheld dot, 9-9 committee split); a hawkish read could set a risk-off tone into Thursday's European open. Confirmed post-release market reaction data was not available at the time of this search — check a live feed after 20:00 CET.
- **Numeric discrepancies across sources on today's exact DAX level** (estimates range from -1.4% to -2.3% on the day) — treat any specific index figure as approximate until confirmed against a primary/live price feed before making any use of it.

Sources cited above are drawn from web search results dated 6-8 July 2026, including NPR, PBS News, Al Jazeera, Euronews, CNBC, NBC News, Trading Economics, Investrade, TechTimes, ING/FXStreet, and third-party technical/chart commentary. Several data points (exact German release times, confirmed DAX earnings dates, precise technical levels, and the exact DAX percentage move today) could not be fully reconciled across sources and are flagged accordingly above. This brief contains no trade recommendations, entries, exits, or position sizing guidance.